

Database Field Explanation Document

Social Recommendation Platform

This document explains every field used in the database collections so API and frontend developers understand what each variable represents and how it is used within the application.

1. Users Collection

Field	Type	Purpose
_id	ObjectId	Unique identifier for each user (primary key).
firstName	String	User's first name displayed on profile.
lastName	String	User's last name displayed on profile.
username	String	Public unique identifier used in profiles and searches.
email	String	Primary login identifier and used for notifications.
passwordHash	String	Secure hashed password instead of storing raw passwords.
emailVerified	Boolean	Indicates whether the user verified their email.
verificationToken	String/null	Temporary token used during email verification.
passwordResetToken	String/null	Temporary token used for resetting passwords.
passwordResetExpires	Date/null	Expiration time for password reset tokens.
bio	String	Short description about the user.
profilePicture	String/null	URL pointing to the user's profile picture.
createdAt	Date	Timestamp when the account was created.
updatedAt	Date	Timestamp when the profile was last modified.

2. Recommendations Collection

Field	Type	Purpose
_id	ObjectId	Unique identifier for each recommendation post.
userId	String	Identifies which user created the recommendation.
title	String	Short title summarizing the recommendation.
category	String	Type of recommendation (movie, tv, music, restaurant, activity, place).
itemName	String	Name of the recommended item or location.
description	String	Explanation for why the item is recommended.
location	String/null	Physical location if the recommendation is a place or activity.

rating	Number	User rating from 1–5.
visibility	String	Defines who can see the post (public or followers).
createdAt	Date	Timestamp when the recommendation was posted.
updatedAt	Date	Timestamp of the most recent update to the recommendation.

3. Follows Collection

Field	Type	Purpose
_id	ObjectId	Unique identifier for the follow relationship.
followerId	String	User who is following another user.
followingId	String	User being followed.
createdAt	Date	Timestamp indicating when the follow occurred.

4. Messages Collection

Field	Type	Purpose
_id	ObjectId	Unique identifier for each message.
senderId	String	User sending the message.
receiverId	String	User receiving the message.
messageText	String	Actual message content.
isRead	Boolean	Indicates whether the receiver has opened the message.
createdAt	Date	Timestamp when the message was sent.

Summary

The database contains four main collections: users, recommendations, follows, and messages. Together these support authentication, recommendation posts, social relationships, and private messaging features within the platform.